

Christine Widden

Software Engineer | Master's in Computer Science

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Summary

Software Engineer with a Master's in Computer Science and experience building automated testing frameworks, evaluating large language models, and developing software for AI, game development, and quality assurance. Strong background in C#, Python, and AI evaluation with hands-on experience using ChatGPT, Gemini, and other LLMs to analyze model behavior, improve software quality, and solve complex technical problems.

Technical Acumen

Programming Languages: Python, C#, JavaScript, TypeScript, C++, C, Java, SQL

Software Engineering: Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions, Software Development Life Cycle, CI/CD, Software Accessibility

Software Testing and Automation: QA Testing, Regression Testing, Playwright, Selenium, TestComplete

Artificial Intelligence and Data Science: Artificial Intelligence, LLM Evaluation, Prompt Engineering, Deep Learning, PyTorch, NumPy

Game Development and Graphics: Unity, Unreal Engine 5, Game Development, Gameplay Systems, Video Game Accessibility, Computer Graphics, OpenGL, GLSL, HLSL, Shaders, Autodesk Maya

Web Development: React, HTML/CSS, Node.js, MongoDB

Operating Systems & Tools: Windows, Linux, Mac, Docker, PowerPoint, Excel

Experience

Laptop Repair Technician, MicroK12

July 2026 - Current

- Complete upwards of 8 diagnoses and repairs of hardware and software problems for student laptops. Replace and repair identified broken parts. Run software and hardware tests, evaluate functionality, and write reports on how the problem was solved, what parts were used, if warranty applies, and cost justification.

Production Support Technician Intern, TerraClear

February 2026 - July 2026

- Performed quality assurance on rock identification datasets to improve model accuracy. Evaluated 200-300 AI-generated annotations per day while maintaining quality standards.
- Managed release processing for 50-100 agricultural rock picking orders per week, queueing and releasing orders through in-house software.
- Collaborated daily with a team of 4 annotators over Slack to review ambiguous classifications and maintain consistent annotation standards.

Software Engineer (Freelance), DataAnnotation

August 2025 - February 2026

- Created and reviewed complex programming tasks across Python, C++, and JavaScript to evaluate and improve AI coding systems.
- Provided detailed technical documentation and feedback on code quality, algorithmic efficiency, and model behavior.

Software Quality Assurance Engineer Intern, Hypertherm

June 2024 - September 2024

- Developed automated Python test scripts in TestComplete to validate multilingual user interfaces, reducing repetitive manual testing.
- Worked closely with 3 QA engineers during SCRUM and Agile meetings to prioritize testing efforts, document defects in Jira, and improve release quality.

Instructional Student Assistant, California Polytechnic State University

September 2023 - March 2024

- Guided 20+ students through debugging and software development in Unity, Unreal Engine, and Godot.
- Supported instruction by grading programming and writing assignments, providing technical feedback.

Software Development Engineer in Test Intern, Symetrix

June 2023 - September 2023

- Built an automated UI test suite containing 60+ end-to-end tests using Playwright and TypeScript after independently learning the framework.
- Met with 3 software engineers during SCRUM and Agile to prioritize testing, troubleshoot failures, review pull requests through GitHub Actions, and improve software quality.
- Used Git, GitHub Actions, Jira, ChatGPT, and CI/CD workflows to maintain test infrastructure and documentation.

Corporate Enterprise Architecture Intern, CompuCom

July 2022 - January 2023

- Automated Excel workflows with Visual Basic macros to reduce repetition by 50% when removing duplicate data.
- Maintained SharePoint sites and collaborated directly with management to develop documentation of enterprise architecture projects.

Education

Master's in Computer Science, California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

September 2023 - June 2025 | Graduated with Distinction | GPA 3.70

Bachelor's in Computer Science, California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

September 2019 - June 2023 | Graduated Cum Laude | GPA 3.66

Relevant Courses:

- Game Design: Developing C#-based games in Unity, alongside an in-depth look into the principles behind good game design.
- Introduction to Computer Security: A hands-on course in computer system and network security. Utilized tools such as Postman and Wireshark to explore networks and learn how to protect against weaknesses.

Projects

Master's Thesis: The Impact of Accessibility Features on Player Experience in Video Games

- Designed a 60-page research study and developed a custom Unity-based testing environment to collect data on user interaction.
- Programmed a Kinematic Character Controller from scratch to ensure consistent gameplay feel and precise movement data collection.

Alien Invasion

- Collaborated on a four-person team to develop a Unity tower defense game in C#.
- Designed a modular object-oriented upgrade system, participated in playtesting sessions, and coordinated feature development through regular team meetings.

Goblin Chase

- A Unity-based 2D platformer and shooter game, developed for the Interactive Entertainment Engineering course.
- Regularly met with the team to ensure efficient and balanced work division.

OpenGL Projects

- Implemented custom vertex and fragment shaders in GLSL to create real-time lighting, texturing, and visual effects in OpenGL.
- Optimized rendering performance by applying fundamental algorithms and data structures in C++.

Maya Projects

- Collaborated on three-person teams to create projects demonstrating 3D modeling, texturing, rigging, animation, and rendering using Autodesk Maya.

Additional Information

US Citizen. Hobbies include digital art, creative writing, tabletop games, and participating in online fandom communities.